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# **SYSTEM 21 EXPLORER**

Version 3.5.2

**Online Help Text**



# FRONTISPIECE

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This Online Help Text relates to System 21 Explorer Version 3.5.2.

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## Glossary of Terms



# Glossary

## Acrobat Printing Problems

JBA issue Help files in .pdf format, for example wm.pdf, for use with Acrobat Viewer. You can print pages directly from Acrobat Viewer, however, there may be a problem where Arial Monospaced font has been used to show excerpts of program code and the printer is not set up correctly to receive this font.

For all fonts to print correctly on your printer you must make sure of the following two things:

- That you have the correct print resolution set up on your PC. You must have 300 dots per inch.
- That you only print from your hard drive or a network drive.

If you do not know how to do this then please take the following steps. You need only do this once:

1. Close Acrobat viewer.
2. Load the .pdf file onto your hard drive on the PC, or to a network drive.



*Note: If the .pdf file has been sent to you via Lotus Notes then please detach to the hard drive*

3. Select Start\Settings\Printers to display the Printers Window.
4. Select your default printer and click with the right mouse button. This displays the pop up menu.
5. Select Properties from the pop up menu.
6. Select the panel with the Resolution field (usually the Graphic panel).
7. Change the Resolution to 300 dots per inch.
8. Click Apply and then OK.
9. Open Acrobat Viewer and resume printing from your .pdf file as normal.

## Action Agents

You create an Action Agent as part of the design of a Business Process on the Constructor Workspace. This is a piece of processing which becomes transparent to the System 21 Explorer user. When you create the Action Agent you create an exception determining program that is configured to route a document down different paths within in a process, dependent on data conditions. You do not need to write a traditional program to support your design, as you would if you used an Elemental Activity.

For example, you could create a Credit Action Agent between the Order Entry activity and the Picking Notes activity, to tell the Business Process how to handle credit checking after the processing for Order Entry. You set up output nodes for the Action Agent which link to pathways within the design, based on a set of rules. You set up the rules to determine which logical pathway the process will

follow. For example you could have a rule so that if the Customer's credit limit exceeded £100 the processing continues on to the Order Cancellation activity.

## Action List

This used to be called To Do List. This is a feature of JBA System 21 Explorer.

This is a list of outstanding activities due to be carried out by a role. These activity entries are displayed in the Role Activity Area, provided that Work Management has been enabled. Work Management adds entries to the list when identifying, on completion of one activity, that the next activity is user controlled. You can select the entry in the list in order to invoke it.

The Action List facility is enabled by the Action List button on the System 21 Explorer Toolbar. The System Administrator can enable and disable this button.

Please also refer to Escalation And Delegation. This is the process whereby Activities which are prompted for a user, by being sent to their Action List, and are not actioned within a configured period, are escalated in priority or escalated to a different user or both.

## Action Tracker

This used to be called Document Status Review.

This is an interactive enquiry facility which enables the System Administrator to view the current status of any Document Type on the database. It determines the progress of documents through their relevant processes and of any child documents created; for example, pick notes and invoices created as part of a sales order process.

You may also launch a pending Document Type.

## Activate

This used to be called Upload. This refers to the loading of files or data from the PC to the Server.

For example, in Constructor there is an Activate option on the Work Management Menu which enables you to select a Business Process and pass it to the Work Management control facility on the Server. Work Management can then run it using the Work Management Engine. Please refer to the Activate Window in Constructor.

Note also the term Retrieve, which used to be called Download.

## Activities

There are two types of Activities:

- Assembled Activities. These are stored in .ACT files.
- Elemental Activities. These are stored in the design-time database.

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- Assembled Activities. These are stored in .ACT files.
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## Activity List

An Activity List is a series of Elemental Activities to be processed sequentially. Each Activity has only one exit node so that as soon as one activity in the list is completed the processing moves straight onto the next activity.

## Activity Lists

Activity Lists are a series of Elemental Activities to be processed sequentially. Each Activity has only one exit node so that as soon as one activity in the list is completed the processing moves straight onto the next activity.

## Activity Shortcut Code

Can be used to launch activities within System 21 Explorer, but only when in Role Menu Designer mode.

This means that they can be used by the System Administrator, or by anyone who has been given Role Menu Designer permissions. You would have to know the code for each activity. For example, you could type in 1/oep, in upper or lower case, and press Return to launch the Order Entry program. This would have exactly the same effect as if you had double clicked on Order Entry in the Role Activity Area.

You enter the code in the box at the top of the Application Browser Area.

## Alias Path Option

This is a Document Viewer facility. It enables you to set up an alias to the File pathway specified on the Register A Document Window. Several documents can be linked to the same alias so that if you need to move documents you can change the alias pathway rather than having to register all the documents again.

## Application Window

This is a JBA System 21 session window. This could be, for example, an Order Entry window.

Each time you activate an activity from Explorer the system starts a new session. The session number is displayed on the Explorer Status Bar. Each new session is displayed as a new window. When the system detects a new window, it centres it on the screen on top of any existing windows.

## Assembled Activities

User defined activities which are broken down into Elemental Activities, Business Methods and Subassemblies.

## Audit

The term used in Explorer to show the current status of Document Types, an audit enquiry. All actions carried out to a document, as part of work Management, are recorded for audit purposes.

## Automatic Batch

One of a number of Execution Modes. Work Management will, on completion of one activity, execute a subsequent activity identified as Automatic Batch by adding the task to a job queue.

## Automatic Immediate

One of a number of Execution Modes. Work Management will, on completion of one activity, execute a subsequent activity identified as Automatic Immediate by adding the task to a job queue that allows multiple active jobs, so usually ensuring an immediate execution of that task.

## Business Method

This is the lowest level software component and cannot be broken down any further. You find them contained within Assembled Activities and Subassemblies.

Business Methods can be Constructables, Consumables or both of these.

## Business Methods

These are the lowest level software components and cannot be broken down any further. You find these contained within Assembled Activities and Subassemblies.

Business Methods can be Constructables, Consumables or both of these.

## Business Object

Now called Document Type.

## Business Object Reference

A specific instance of a Business Object identified by a reference or transaction number. For example, a journal identified by company, type and number.

## Business Process

This is at the top level of the business function.

Within a Business Process it is possible to have Elemental Activities, Assembled Activities and other Business Processes. Business Processes can be nested to several levels.

However, there are restrictions on the way in which you construct Business Processes depending on whether you use Constructor as a design tool for Enterprise Modelling or a configuration tool for Work Management.

If the Business Process is to be uploaded to Work Management these rules apply:

- Assembled activities cannot be present
- Nesting can only be to one level down
- At the top level, a nested Business Process must be linked to an end node
- A User Selected Path cannot link into a Parallel Path.

There may be other restrictions in place, but the validation will highlight these.

## Business Processes

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## Business Process Code

Sometimes displayed on screen as Process Code.

This code uniquely identifies the Business Process to the Work Management Engine, whereas it is the name of the Business Process which uniquely identifies the Business Process to Constructor and to the design-time database on the PC.

When you work with a Business Process on Constructor's Workspace you can change the Code using the Properties option on the Workspace pop up menu. You can then save the Business Process, with the new Code, to the design-time database on the PC.

However, if you Activate the Business Process the Work Management Engine checks the Business Process Code, not the Business Process name, and saves the Business Process to the Work Management tables on the server, where the Business Process Code is now the key to the Business Process.

If the Business Process Code is new to the Work Management tables then a new file is created with a version number 001. However, if that Business Process Code already exists the Work Management Engine creates a new file for the Business Process but increments the version number. In this way all Business Processes are version controlled on the server, as identified by the Code, whereas only the latest copy of the Business Process is held on the PC and is identified by its name.

## Cancellation

This is the cancellation of a pending activity. When a pending activity is executed the function may decide, because of certain circumstances or data conditions, that it is no longer possible to continue with the process for a Document Type, for example the cancellation of an order. Because there may be multiple paths through a process, and therefore more than one state for a Document Type, all pending transactions for the Document Type are cancelled. This is achieved by the Completion Action setting of 1 against a completion code.

## Child

This is a process which is initiated by another process. The process which is initiated from an external event and may link to other, child, processes is called a parent process. A child process, can identify a Business Process either as a result of their invocation, via Work Management or via the Action List, or from the Document Types which are selected. For example, where Pick Notes and Invoices are created as part of a Sales Order process then Pick Notes and Invoices are child processes creating child documents. Sales Order is the parent process.

## Client

Usually a PC, an intelligent terminal which sends data to, and receives data from, the Server.

## Client Workspace

JBA System 21 Client Workspace is 16bit software which provides a single point of access to JBA System 21 applications and to those applications that run under Microsoft Windows.

It launches tasks through user configurable Soft Menus. These Soft Menus are pull down options from the menu bar.

There is an advanced facility which enables the System Administrator to reformat the application windows (see Client Workspace Designer).

## Client Workspace Designer

This is an integral part of JBA System 21 Client Workspace. When you install Client Workspace you also install Designer. Designer enables the System Administrator to tailor the System 21 window display for the Client Workspace user.

## Clipping

Clipping is the term used to describe the way in which lines can be hidden from the screen display.

## Cloud

This is a colloquial term for the Data Exchange Area.

## Completion

The point at which an activity finishes its processing on a Document Type, writes transaction completion details and informs the Work Management Engine it has completed.

## Completion Action

The action to be taken against each completion code. The default setting of 0 means the next activity on this path will be processed as normal and with the same thread identifier. A setting of 2 is again the normal execution of the next activity on the path but with a new thread identifier. Used for activities that combine Document Types - see Threads. A setting of 1 is Cancellation which will cancel all pending transactions for the Document Type.

## Completion Codes

Synonymous in Constructor with Exit Nodes, they are the possible exit conditions for an activity. In the Constructor model each completion node is linked via a path to the next activity. The relationship between activity completion and next activity

is established in the Work Management tables, and used by the processing engine to identify the next task to be performed.

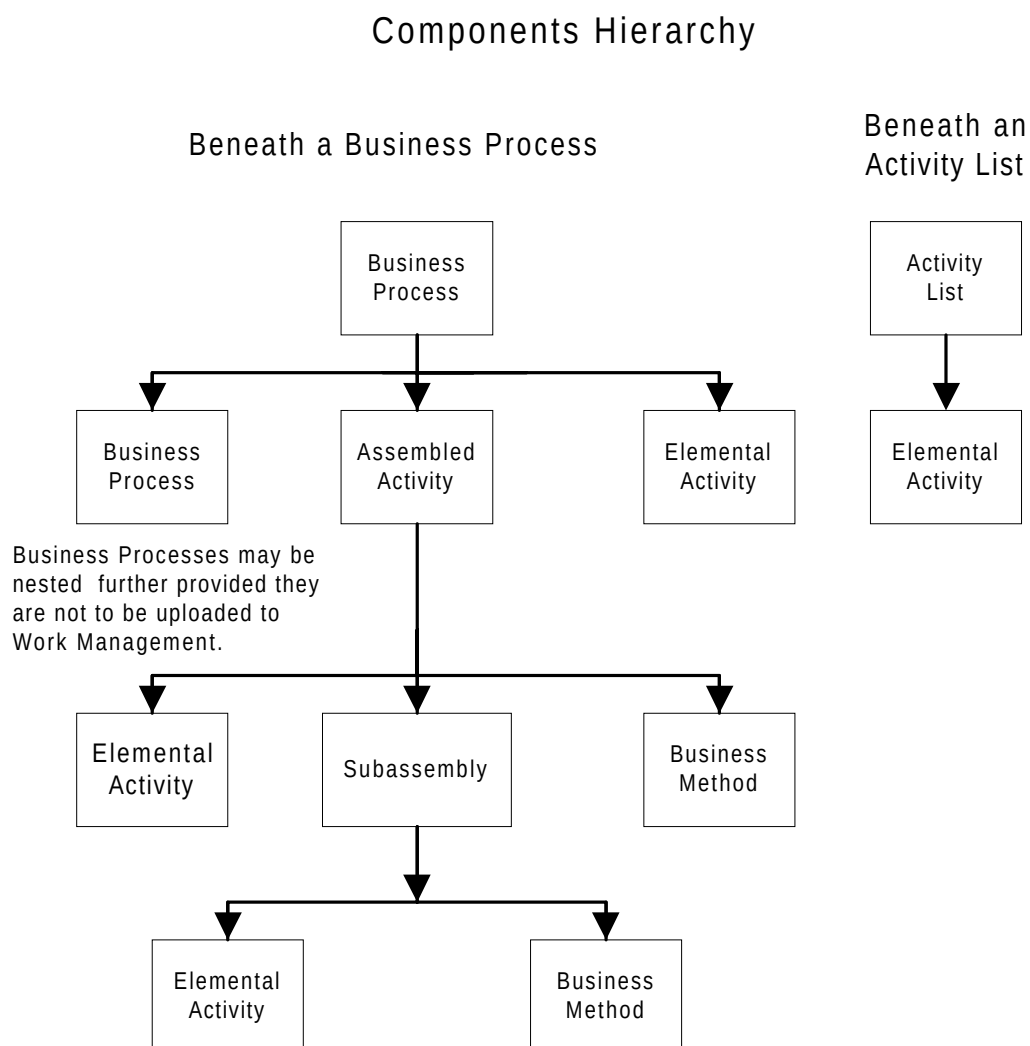
## Component

A Component is a part of the design of a business system. It can be an Assembled Activity, an Elemental Activity, a Business Method, a Constructable or a Consumable.

## Components

Components are a part of the design of a business system. They can be Assembled Activities, Elemental Activities, Business Methods, Constructables or Consumables.

## Components Hierarchy Diagram



## Connections

These are lines which link the components together to form a continuous process.

## Constructable

A constructable is a component which has to be called and executed. It can be an Elemental Activity or a Business Method. It can contain Consumables.

## Constructables

Constructables are components which have to be called and executed. They can be Elemental Activities or Business Methods. They can contain Consumables.

## Constructor

Constructor is a framework generator tool that enables you to construct your business system using a hierarchy of components. Constructor integrates fully with Work Management and System 21 Explorer. Using a Windows environment you model your system design on a Workspace, incorporating System 21 application components. You decide the components and then link them together to form a logical business structure.

Components are grouped hierarchically:

- The top level in the hierarchy consists of the Business Processes.
- The middle level consists of the Assembled Activities, Elemental Activities, Activity Lists and Subassemblies.
- The bottom level consists of the Business Methods.

A design should ideally be started at the bottom level so that the top level finally incorporates all the lower levels. Please refer to the Components Hierarchy Diagram. You can use Constructor in one of three ways:

- As a design tool for the construction of Assembled Activities.
- As a design tool for Enterprise Modelling.
- As a graphical design/configuration tool for Work Management. You configure the design of a Business Process and upload it to the Work Management Engine. Work Management then controls the flow of work through Explorer by initiating activities and managing Action Lists.

System 21 enables a customer to integrate standard System 21 components in conjunction with their own bespoke components, based on Microsoft ActiveX technologies. At each stage in the design process you can validate the design so that you can be certain that it is viable.

You can preview and execute Business Methods, Activities, Activity Lists and Subassemblies from within Constructor. Although you cannot directly execute a Business Process in Constructor you can perform a walkthrough to verify the flow of control between the configured components. You can launch the underlying System 21 application components individually.

## Consumable

A consumable is an executable Business Method which is used to contain programming function which can easily be changed. For example, a selection of tax codes and calculations would be stored as consumables so that different processing could be applied when a user changes a tax code.

## Consumables

Consumables are executable Business Methods which are used to contain programming function which can easily be changed. For example, a selection of tax codes and calculations would be stored as consumables so that different processing could be applied when a user changes a tax code.

## Context Sensitive

Within Explorer and Constructor this refers to functionality which varies depending on the context from which it was launched. Pop up menus are context sensitive and their options vary depending on which part of Explorer or Constructor you choose to click with the right mouse button. These are often referred to as right click menus. For example, in Constructor you can click on the Workspace with the right mouse button to display the Workspace Menu.

## Currency Triangulation

During the Euro transition phase, currencies which are participating must be calculated in a three point format known as triangulation. The source currency value is converted to an interim Euro value which is, in turn, converted to the target currency value.

## Data Exchange Area

A storage area on the computer which is used for passing parameters (variables) from one piece of JBA program code to another at runtime, regardless of deployment. This used to be called the Cloud.

## Data Field

A variable which is resolved for each document at run time.

## Data Fields

Variables which are resolved for each document at run time.

## Data Source

An ODBC definition which shows the location of the data brought back by the ODBC. Please refer to the ODBC Glossary Definition.

## DDE

Dynamic Data Exchange.

## DEA

Data Exchange Area.

## Default Business Process

The Default Business Process field will be used for initial activities where the activity has no input Document Type. If a default business process is entered then this will be picked up by the activity on completion. This could then be passed into a new global activity which would be used to determine the business process which the Document Type is to be processed.

## Default System

The default system is used to launch an Elemental Activity, for which a system has not been assigned using the Properties Window. The default system is initially the first server to which your machine connects, but then you can redefine the default by using a field in the Preferences Window.

## Delegation

This is a Constructor facility and is an option on the Work Management Menu: please refer to the Escalation And Delegation Window.

Delegation means moving an item automatically from one user's Action List to another user's Action List. You could use this where someone was on holiday or absent for a period of time so that the items would appear only in the Action List of the user who was taking over that activity.

## Designer

JBA have two Designer products:

- Client Workspace Designer
- Explorer Designer.

## DNS

Domain Name Server or Domain Naming System. This translates Domain Names, for example, jba.co.uk, into IP Addresses, for example, 193.128.27.34.

## Document Status Review

Now called Action Tracker.

## Document Type

Used to be called Business Object.

A document, order, or any other kind of similar entity, on which a job of work is performed, for example a sales order or a financial journal. Activities are identified with Document Types.

An activity has a single input Document Type on which it operates, for example a sales order, although potentially it has multiple output Document Types, for example despatch notes and invoices.

Each activity can only be joined to an exit condition relating to the same Document Type as its input Document Type; for example, the pick note exit conditions from pick note generation can only be joined to an activity having pick note as its input Document Type for example pick note print.

Where no Document Type is associated with a condition, this can be joined to other conditions with no Document Type specified.

## Document Viewer

This is a facility which enables the System Administrator to maintain a database of documents which can then be linked to System 21 Application Windows, Elemental Activities or third-party programs. For example you could use this facility to display company procedures at the start of an application or display catalogue photographs alongside product details.

## Double Click

This means click twice in rapid succession with the left mouse button. Usually this launches some programming function or opens a file.

## Download

This is now called Retrieve. This refers to the loading of files or data from the Server to the PC.

For example, in Explorer, on the System Configuration Visual Components Window, you can state how you want to download Visual Components.

For example, in Constructor there is a Retrieve option on the Work Management Menu which enables you to select items such as Data Fields and Document Types and retrieve them from the design-time database on the Server.

Note also the term Upload which is now called Activate.

## Dynamic Data Exchange

This is a interface which enables one program to talk to another. For example Microsoft Word and System 21 Explorer both have DDE interfaces which means that Word can be called from System 21 Explorer and documents accessed.

To do this you use the sticky fields facility where you are allocated a field in System 21 to be accessible to the third party application.

## Elemental Activities

JBA activities on the server which cannot be broken down any further.

## Email

As part of a design on the Constructor workspace you can set up an E-mail message to request manual intervention.

## End Condition

This is one of the process controls which you drag onto a new design to complete the design. Business Processes, Assembled Activities and Subassemblies can have any number of End Conditions but Activity Lists must have only one.

## Enterprise Modelling

You can use Constructor, with its hierarchical grouping of components, to demonstrate to a customer how the System 21 solution is applicable to their individual requirements.

To do this you take a customer's Business Process and graphically represent it on Constructor's Workspace and then map onto it the various System 21 activities.

Where communications links are available, from Constructor to the host system, you can launch System 21 Activities directly from the Workspace.

## Error Handling

User executed activities that operate with screens or Windows will have any Work Management error or validation messages directed to the user's screen. Batch and background activities have their error messages directed to the role

associated to those activities, the users operating under that role being informed of such an error condition by an entry in their Action List.

## Error Role

The role identified with automatic or scheduled tasks to which any error messages will be directed.

## Escalation

This is a Constructor facility and is an option on the Work Management Menu: please refer to the Escalation And Delegation Window.

Escalation means moving an item from one user's Action List to another user's Action List after a period of time. You could use this for example if a manager wanted to pick up all activities outstanding after time. Instead of moving the item to another list you could give it a higher priority after a period of time so that it moved higher up the same Action List.

## Escalation And Delegation

This is a Constructor facility and is an option on the Work Management Menu: please refer to the Escalation And Delegation Window.

Escalation And Delegation is the process whereby Activities which are prompted for a user, by being sent to their Action List, and are not actioned within a configured period, are escalated in priority or escalated to a different user, or both.

Escalation means moving an item from one user's Action List to another user's Action List after a period of time. You could use this, for example, if a manager wanted to pick up all activities outstanding after time. Instead of moving the item to another list, you could give it a higher priority after a period of time, so that it moved higher up the same Action List.

Delegation means moving an item automatically from one user's Action List to another user's Action List. You could use this where someone was on holiday or absent for a period of time, so that the items would appear only in the Action List of the user who was taking over that activity.

## EWM

Enterprise Work Management.

## Execution Modes

There are four basic execution modes; User Controlled, Automatic Immediate, Automatic Batch and Scheduled Batch. An activity is normally identified with one form of execution, although if the function's programming permits, it may be allowed any mix of these, then when defining the execution path a specific mode is chosen for that instance. Designers can also create their own modes.

## Exit Condition

See Completion Codes.

## Explorer

Explorer is 32 bit software and provides a single point of access to JBA System 21 applications and to those applications that run under Microsoft Windows.

Applications are launched from a series of role menus, designed to reflect the activities performed by the people within the organisation. For example there could be one role menu for all the Sales Order Clerks, another one for the Inventory Clerks and so on.

There are advanced facilities, designed for a System Administrator, which can be switched on and off :

- Role Menu Designer enables you to design role menus to tailor your system to meet your business needs so that individual users can be screened from sensitive applications.
- System Configuration enables you to configure the system for the users.
- Explorer Designer enables you to reformat the application windows.
- User/Role Maintenance enables you maintain a list of users in the database and a list of authorised role menus for each user.
- Document Status Review enables you to view the current status of any Document Type on your database. You may also launch a pending Document Type.
- Document Viewer enables you to maintain a database of documents which can then be linked to System 21 Application Windows, Elemental Activities or third-party programs.
- Email Server Agent forwards email messages generated by the Work Management Engine.

## Explorer Designer

This is an integral part of System 21 Explorer. When you install Explorer you also install Designer. Designer enables the System Administrator to tailor the System 21 window display for the Explorer user.

## Explorer Window

This is a window which enables you to exploit the features which Explorer has to offer. For example: The Preferences Window.

You can display the Explorer windows by selecting options from both the Explorer Main Menu Bar and the Explorer context sensitive pop up menus. See also Application Window.

## Export

In Constructor there is an Export option on the File Menu which enables you to export a Business Process from one PC to another.

## Global Activities

Activities that are not associated to specific Document Types. Currently only utilised for a specific function Thread Consolidation.

## Goal Posted

This expression is used to describe windows which do not display properly, often with just three sides of black, on a grey border - hence the name. However, more commonly it is used to describe any window with an incorrect display.

## Green-On-Black

AS/400 character-based screens (GOB). They are so described because of the green lettering on a black background.

JBA's System 21 green-on-black screens are being replaced by Visual Components.

## Grid Box

This is a JBA feature and not a Microsoft feature.

It is a table of information where you can use each cell of the table as a standard Windows field. If you click with the left mouse button the cell becomes either a text box or a list box for you to select or enter information. This is an example taken from Constructor.

|  | Mode | Description         | Processor | Processor type | Function |
|--|------|---------------------|-----------|----------------|----------|
|  | 10   | User invoked        | OE 0331   | TASK           |          |
|  | 20   | Automatic Immediate | OE 0331   | TASK           |          |
|  | 30   | Automatic Batch     | OE 0331   | TASK           |          |

Tip: Click with the right mouse button under the toolbar to display the first row.

The functionality may vary between software applications but these are some of the features which you may have:

- Add, delete and copy rows.
- Export the entire contents into Microsoft Excel.
- Select a single cell or a row of cells or the entire table. If you highlight the row and then click with the right mouse button you display a context-sensitive pop up menu.

- There may be a Customise option on the pop up menu, with these suboptions:  
View - Displays the Column Window - change column headings and positions.  
Font - Change the Font for the headings.  
Colour - change the colour of the foreground and background.  
Reset - Undo any custom changes.
- There may be a context-sensitive pop up menu behind the Heading row to enable you to resize the Column width, to match the title or the space available, or to hide the column altogether.

## Host

Another term to describe the Server - the main platform on which the Database resides - which sends data to, and receives data from, the Client.

## Import

In Constructor there is an Import option on the File Menu which enables you to import a Business Process from one PC to another.

## Initial Activity

An Initial Activity is the first activity in a Business Process, and because of this requires special conditioning associated to it.

A parent process is one which is initiated from an external event and may link to other, child, processes. Second or subsequent activities in a parent process, as well as all activities in a child process, can identify a Business Process either as a result of their invocation, via Work Management or via the Action List, or from the Document Types which are selected. However, the first activity in a parent process cannot identify the process in this way.

An activity can be included in the designs for more than one Business Process, for example, Order Entry. The EWM Engine does not recognise that the activity is enabled for Work Management until the order is created, and at this point the Business Process is not known and may vary according to the order created.

As soon as the EWM Engine recognises that the activity is enabled for Work Management it checks to see if it is an Initial Activity. It then checks all the Business Processes to find the ones for which this activity in question is the Initial Activity. It then displays a list of all these Business Processes and the Explorer user identifies the appropriate process.

## Input Field

This is a field into which you type data.

## Logon

Logging on is not the first activity you have to perform in System 21 Constructor

or System 21 Explorer. You log on to the system only when you start an activity. Not all activities may be connected to the same host system so you may have to logon more than once depending on which activities you start. You can optionally assign a system to each elemental activity, by using the Properties Window. Any elemental activity which does not have a system assigned uses the default system.

## Magic Number

This is an identification number for a window. A window has to have a Magic Number if you want to redesign the window using System 21 Explorer Designer. Designer checks that this number exists on the database before it will let you make any changes to the window.

The only time you see the number is if you use the Add Help button in Designer. The number for the current window is displayed for you.

## Manual Activities

You create a Manual Activity as part of the design of a Business Process on the Constructor Workspace. This is a way of allowing the System 21 Explorer user to have an input to the process.

You can display messages for the Explorer user either for information (for example, Order received) or to instruct non System 21 activity to be carried out, typically in response to an exception triggered in the process; for example, Phone customer as the EDI order was incorrectly priced.

For example, you could enable the user to decide what to do about failed credit checks. You might display a message explaining that the customer has exceeded their credit limit and advise them to contact the customer to resolve the situation.

You could place buttons on the window to enable the user to perform a credit inquiry or view orders. This processing would be conceptually at a tangent to the processing on the Workspace.

You could place buttons on the window to enable the user to Release the Order or Cancel the Order. This processing would be part of the design on the Workspace, represented by lines connected to output nodes from the Manual Activity.

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For example, you could enable the user to decide what to do about failed credit checks. You might display a message explaining that the customer has exceeded their credit limit and advise them to contact the customer to resolve the situation.

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You could place buttons on the window to enable the user to Release the Order or Cancel the Order. This processing would be part of the design on the Workspace, represented by lines connected to output nodes from the Manual Activity.

## Manual Forwarding

This is where Action List entries are forwarded to other users.

## MDI

Multiple Document Interface. More than one document can be open on the Workspace at any one time. The Window drop down menu displays a list of open documents. Select a document from the list to bring it to the front so you can see it.

## Model

The pictorial construction of a business process, its activities and paths in Constructor.

## Monospaced Font

A Monospaced Font is a character set which uses single character spacing for all characters, regardless of their relative size. For example - the letters A, I and W could be regarded as average, narrow and wide in size - a monospaced font would give each of them the same amount of room on the screen.

## Multi Document Processing

Identifies where an activity can process multiple Document Types in one execution, or whether it will operate for a single Document Type only. This option is established for an activity against the mode of execution but can be overridden on any instance of the execution of the activity, that is on the execution details for a completion node path. Useful override where a process, such as a document print, can run automatically for a single order, but also in a batch mode to print many orders.

## Multi Thread

See Threads.

## Nesting Business Processes

You can drag a Business Process onto the Workspace of another Business Process in Constructor. This is how to nest Business Processes. You can nest to several levels provided that you do not want to upload the Business Process to Work Management control. Work Management allows nesting to two levels only, including the top level.

Note that the nested symbol has a cross in the centre and if it has more than one Start Condition then the symbol also has a yellow dot to the left hand side of the circle.

These Start Condition defaults apply to nested Business Processes:

### Firstly:

If the calling component in the top level Business Process has a Document Type defined in its Properties then by default Constructor will use this to match up with a Start Condition for the second level Business Process. For example this Document Type might be SALESORDER.

### Secondly:

You can override the first default condition by using the Select Start Node Window to select which start node you want to use for the second level Business Process, when it gets called by the top level Business Process. Select Start Node is an option on the Business Process Link pop up menu.

### Thirdly:

However, it is possible for the second level Business Process to have more than one Start Condition with the same Document Type. For example there may be two Start Conditions defined with SALESORDER, in which case you would need to specify which one to use. To do this you check the Default Start Node For This Document Types box on the Start Details Window, to define which one is to be the default.

## Node

The symbols on the Constructor Workspace may have circular segments to the right side of the centre circle. These are referred to as Exit Nodes. These nodes represent the exit points from the component, for example for Save and Cancel buttons. To amend the node details use the Properties Window.

A Start Condition has only one exit node.

## Nodes

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A Start Condition has only one exit node.

## ODBC

Open Database Connectivity. This is Microsoft-defined technology and refers to the provision of standard interfaces to many databases. ODBC is a vehicle for translating SQL statements, sending requests to the database and bringing back the data. For example a PC application might want to access an AS/400 database that is managed by the AS/400 operating system. The PC would use ODBC to interface to the database.

Microsoft provide an ODBC Administrator where you can determine the driver settings for each database. See the Settings\Control Panel option on your Start menu. If you have written your SQL statements correctly you can direct a machine to any database by changing the ODBC settings.

## OLE

This refers to program integration technology used to share information between programs. All the Microsoft Office programs support OLE, so you can share information through linked and embedded objects.

A linked object refers to information that is created in one file (the source file) and inserted into another file (the destination file) while maintaining a connection between the two files. The linked object in the destination file is automatically updated when the source file is updated. A linked object does not become part of the destination file.

An embedded object refers to information that is inserted into a file (the destination file). Once embedded, the object becomes part of the destination file. When you double click an embedded object, it opens in the program (source program) it was created in. Any changes you make to the embedded object are reflected in the destination file.

## Orthogonal

Containing right angles.

## Output Field

This is a field used for displaying text. An example of this might be a field name or a heading.

## Parallel Path

This is one of the Constructor process controls which you drag onto a design where you want the logical pathway through a Business Process to split into two or more parallel pathways. Processing takes place along the parallel pathways simultaneously. For example, a Business Process containing order entry procedures might split into two parallel pathways so that on one pathway there could be processing to print pick notes and on the other pathway there could be processing to print order acknowledgements.

Parallel processing can only take place on the Server, under Work Management control, and not on the PC. For this reason you can have a Parallel Path only within a Business Process.

Business Processes can have any number of Parallel Paths but Assembled Activities, Subassemblies and Activity Lists cannot have any at all.

See also User Selected Path.

## Parent

A parent is a process which is initiated from an external event and may link to other, child, processes. Second or subsequent activities in a parent process, as well as all activities in a child process, can identify a Business Process either as a result of their invocation, via Work Management or via the Action List, or from the Document Types which are selected. However, the Initial Activity in a parent process cannot identify the process in this way.

For example, where pick notes and invoices are created as part of a Sales Order process then Pick Notes and Invoices are child processes creating child documents. Sales Order is the parent process.

## PDF Files

Files with an extension of .pdf are acrobat files. Please refer to Acrobat Printing Problems.

## Pending

Activities that are next to be processed have transactions of a pending status.

## Pop Up

Pop up menus are context sensitive and their options vary depending on which part of Explorer or Constructor you choose to click with the right mouse button. These are often referred to as right click menus. For example, in Constructor you can click on the Workspace with the right mouse button to display the Workspace Menu. This is a pop up, context sensitive, menu.

## Process Code

This is the name on the screen but it is also known as Business Process Code. Change this by right clicking on the Start Node of a process in Constructor.

Warning: If you change this and it is not unique then the existing one will be overwritten by the new one when it is activated.

## Process Control

This is used to mark the start and end of the Business Processes and Activities and to influence the pathways between components. They include Start and End Conditions, User Selected Paths, Parallel Paths, Manual Activities and Action Agents.

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## Process Performance

As documents pass through a process each activity is time-stamped, before and after execution, to provide the base data for the analysis of process performance and bottlenecks.

## Proportional Font

A Proportional Font is a character set which uses variable character spacing for all characters, depending on their relative size. For example - the letters A, I and W could be regarded as average, narrow and wide in size - a proportional font would adjust the spacing on the screen, so that the 'I' would have less space than the 'A', and the 'W' would have more space.

## Reason Codes

The reason a Document Type has been given a particular completion code coming out of an activity, effectively a sub division of the completion code state. Useful where a function has many reasons why a particular state arises but the business process only needs one output path through to the next activity. The reason codes are shown on the audit and trace enquiries.

## Registration Id

All Business Processes, Assembled Activities, Subassemblies and Activity Lists have a unique Registration Id.

For Constructor version 3.5.2.d and earlier it was the case that if you created any of these components by using New or SaveAs from the File Menu then a unique Registration Id was created for you. You could then select Register Files from the File Menu and register the file you had just created.

For Constructor Version 3.5.2e and later this Registration Id is transparent. Files no longer have to be registered because Business Processes, Assembled Activities, Subassemblies and Activity Lists are saved directly to the design-time

database and not to the PC. However, you may be notified with the Registration Id when Importing files.

## Retrieve

This used to be called Download. This refers to the loading of files or data from the Server to the PC.

For example, in Constructor there is a Retrieve option on the Work Management Menu which enables you to select items such as Data Fields and Document Types and retrieve them from the design-time database on the Server.

Note also the term Activate, which used to be called Upload.

## Right Click

This means click once with the right mouse button. Usually this displays a context sensitive pop up menu from which you can select further options.

## Role



*Note: This is an Explorer feature and is not available in Client Workspace, .*

See also Role Code and Role Menu.

A role in System 21 Explorer is a job title to which certain activities are assigned. For example, a typical role might be that of Sales Order Clerk, to which the activities of order entry and order acknowledgement might have been assigned. The users who have been given Sales Order Clerk permissions will then be able to perform these activities from the Sales Order Clerk's role menu.

## Role Code



*Note: Not available in Client Workspace, this is an Explorer feature.*

See also Role and Role Menu.

If you want to make full use of the Work Management facility then you must assign role codes to role menus. Each role menu has a unique role code.

Your System Administrator may want to give you these permissions:

- To define a role code for an existing role menu. To do this use the Role Code Window.
- To create a role code at the same time as creating a new role menu. To do this use the User Role Maintenance facility.

## Role Menu



*Note: Not available in Client Workspace, this is an Explorer feature.*

See also Role and Role Code.

A Role Menu is a collection of activities available to a person assigned to a particular role within the organisation.

System 21 Explorer provides the System Administrator with a comprehensive facility to design role menus to tailor a system to meet business needs. This facility can be switched on and off so that individual users can be screened from sensitive applications.

For example: You might have an Order Entry Clerk role menu designed specifically for the order entry clerk. On this menu would be all the activities which the order entry clerk would be expected to undertake, such as Order Entry; Order Cancellation; Enter Credit Notes; Stock Allocation. The PC used by this clerk would be enabled only for that role menu and each of the activities could be put onto the desk top for easy access.

Role menus are stored in .rmu files.

## SCC

Supply Chain Council.

This is an independent non-profit-making corporation which attempts to encourage best practice by companies operating within the supply-chain.

It was organised in 1996 by Pittiglio Rabin Todd & McGrath (PRTM) and Advanced Manufacturing Research (AMR), and initially included 69 voluntary member companies. Council membership is now open to all companies and organisations interested in applying and advancing state-of-the-art supply-chain management systems and practices. Member companies pay a modest annual fee to support Council business. All who use the SCOR model are asked to acknowledge the SCC in all documents describing or depicting the SCOR model and its use. All who use SCOR are encouraged to join the SCC, both to further model development and to obtain the full benefits of membership. Further information regarding the Council and SCOR can be found at the Council's Web site: [www.supply-chain.com](http://www.supply-chain.com).

## Scheduler

The activity scheduler is a background processor that, working with the schedule rules, identifies when pending transactions marked Scheduled should be processed, and then, when appropriate, queues those tasks.

## SCOR

Supply-Chain Operations Reference-model.

Developed and endorsed by the Supply Chain Council (SCC), SCOR is the cross-industry standard for supply-chain management and is freely available to all who wish to use the standard reference model. System 21 is fully compatible with the SCOR model as Constructor's modelling capabilities demonstrate.

SCOR spans:

- All customer interactions, from order entry through paid invoice.

- All physical material transactions, from your supplier's supplier to your customer's customer, including: equipment, supplies, spare parts, bulk product, software.
- All market interactions, from the understanding of aggregate demand to the fulfilment of each order.

SCOR does not include:

- Sales administration processes.
- Technology development processes.
- Product and process design and development processes.
- Post-delivery customer support operations including technical support processes.

SCOR notes those links to processes that are not included within the model's scope.

## Scheduled Batch

One of a number of Execution Modes. Work Management will, on completion of one activity, execute a subsequent activity identified as Scheduled Batch when the identified schedule date and time becomes current.

## Server

The Server is the main platform on which the System 21 Applications and Database reside - which transfers data to the Client.

## SMU

An acronym for Soft Menu Utility.

## Soft Menu

A term used to describe a menu which can be altered by the user.

## Start Condition

This is one of the process controls which you drag onto a new design at the beginning. Business Processes can have any number of Start Conditions but Assembled Activities, Subassemblies and Activity Lists must have only one.

## Sticky Field

This is an input or output field where the value entered into it is saved to a storage area. Other activity windows or external applications can then read to or write from these sticky fields.

For example: Locating all details about an item may require the execution of several enquiries. By nominating the item reference as a sticky field in the first enquiry you could enable subsequent enquiries to be accessed without further rekeying of the item code.

You can transfer data to Microsoft Word by nominating, for example, the fields of an invoice as sticky fields and accessing them from Word using the DDE interface.

## Subassembly

A Subassembly is a logical collection of Business Methods. It is used to group together the more frequently used Business Methods to save time when designing. You find Subassemblies within Assembled Activities.

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## System 21 Interface

JBA provide interfaces to their System 21 applications and to those applications that run under Microsoft Windows:

- System 21 Client Workspace
- System 21 Explorer
- System 21 Constructor.

Separate online help text is provided with each of these interfaces.

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## System Administrator

This is a person who has responsibility for organising the files within the computer system, installing software, solving problems, issuing passwords and controlling user access. This would most likely be a senior analyst/programmer or a JBA representative.

## System Configuration

This is installed alongside JBA System 21 Explorer as part of JBA's Administration Tools.

System Configuration enables the System Administrator to configure the options available to the person using Explorer or Constructor by enabling or disabling various facilities for them.

You can open System Configuration either from your Windows Start menu, by selecting Programs, JBA System 21, System Configuration or from the Preferences Window in System 21 Explorer or System 21 Constructor.

It runs expconfig.exe and updates the jbasmg.ini file.

## Technical Reference

An enquiry facility providing a complete cross-reference of server application programs, databases, activities and menus for JBA System 21 applications. It is designed for you to explore in detail the technical structure of the System 21 product.

It is primarily intended for Designers who want to perform an impact analysis. For example you might want to add a new field to the Item Master File and are aware that this could impact on every program which uses the file. You could use Technical Reference to find out the names of all the programs which use the Item Master File. This is a simple example but Technical Reference does enable you to navigate freely and make enquiries to numerous logical levels.

There are three standard environments: Generic, Drinks and Style. This software is installed as part of the Administration Tools installation, but you must purchase the databases separately.

## Thread Activities

Each activity transaction in a thread is given an incremental number to identify the sequence in which the activities were processed.

## Threads

All activities executed in a business process for a specific Document Type are tied together automatically with a thread identifier, that is, each transaction spawned from the original transaction in the initial activity are all associated with the same thread identification code. An exception occurs when an activity is encountered that can merge multiple input Document Type references to one or more output Document Types, when a new thread identifier is allocated. This Multi Thread identification is automatically cross referenced to each input thread.

## Three-dots

Explorer and Constructor use an ellipsis button, with three dots, alongside a field to indicate that there is more information to follow. If you click this button it will enable you to browse for this information.

## To Do List

This is now called Action List. This is a feature of JBA System 21 Explorer.

## Tooltips

Pop up information to assist users.

## Trace

The recording of a transaction for the execution of every activity gives visibility of all work performed by Work Management enabled processes in System 21. The tying together of all activities, their transactions and particular completion statuses with the thread identifiers, allows traceability, of a Document Type showing the sequence of steps undertaken, and auditability with details available of the users and date and time of execution.

## Transaction

A transaction is written for every activity that is processed by Work Management, that is one transaction record for each activity performed on one Document Type. Where an activity produces multiple output conditions a further file hold details of those individual completion details, each one of these potentially initiating a new activity.

## Transaction Status

Transactions have an initial status of Pending, indicating that the activity and Document Type associated to the transaction is waiting to be processed (maybe now, maybe later). When the activity task is in progress the status temporarily goes to Active, then when the activity is finished the status is Complete.

These statuses are set in different places. When a task is started and program has passed the Work Management validation checks the status is set to active. The program on finishing with a particular Document Type will write a trigger record to inform the Work Management engine that it has completed. The engine then detects the completion trigger and marks the original transaction completed and generates, as required, further new transactions with a pending status. The exception is the initial activity in a business process where there was no preceding activity that could initiate the first transaction as pending, so this first transaction will be created in an active state.

## Triggers

These are data queue entries which twin with the transaction completion details file. Each trigger represents a single completion code for a Document Type. At the end of the processing for a Document Type the Work Management engine detects and processes these triggers and then removes them.

## Upgrade

An Upgrade of the System 21 software is identified by a letter at the end of the Software release number. For example 3.5.2e where e is a version of 3.5.2. Upgrades can be Full or PIP but both of these are represented by a new letter.

A Full Upgrade provides completely new software and has information files called EXPREADME.TXT, CONREADME.TXT and VERREADME.TXT.

A PIP Upgrade provides a short-term product improvement and updates only a limited number of files. A PIP Upgrade has information files called EXP352v.TXT and CON352v.TXT, where v is the version identifier.

## Upload

This is now called Activate. This refers to the loading of files or data from the PC to the Server.

For example, in Constructor there is an Activate option on the Work Management Menu which enables you to select a Business Process and pass it to the Work Management control facility on the Server. Work Management can then run it using the Work Management Engine. Please refer to the Activate Window in Constructor.

Note also the term Download, which is now called Retrieve.

## URL

Uniform Resource Locator. This is a World Wide Web location.

## User Controlled

One of a number of Execution Modes. Work Management will, on completion of one activity, recognise subsequent activities identified as User Invoked and add that activity to an Acton List. The appropriate role for the Action list entry is the role associated with that new activity execution, the Acton List entry carrying details of the specific Document Type to be processed by the user.

## User Selected Path

This is one of the Constructor process controls which you drag onto a design, where you want the logical pathway through a Business Process to split into multiple-option pathways, and the user to intervene to select which pathway to follow.

For example, a Business Process containing order entry procedures might have a choice of three types of processes: one choice might be to schedule a job to print pick notes; a second choice might be to inform a user, with a particular role, that suspended order release is required, via an Action List entry; and a third choice might be to inform a user, with a particular role, that manual allocation is required, via an Action List entry.

Business Processes, Assembled Activities and Subassemblies can have any number of User Selected Paths but Activity Lists cannot have any at all.

See also Parallel Path.

## User/Role Maintenance

This is a System 21 Explorer facility which enables the System Administrator to:

- Maintain a list of users in the database.
- Maintain a list of authorised role menus for each user.

## Validation

The term used to describe the checks made by Constructor to establish if a Business Process is viable. Click on the Validate button on the Toolbar.

This validates the design by checking that the process you have defined meets the rules for the basic design criteria. Constructor displays the Validation Progress Report Window, which displays a list for you to examine, and then correct, any errors.

The list tells you whether all the output nodes are connected, whether all the input conditions are satisfied, whether all the necessary connections have been made, and whether all the consumables are present and correct.

## Variable Substitution Engine

Manual Activities and Action Agents rely on their ability to access data, on or related to the document being processed, to form their message and decide the next routing point. This data is calculated for each document, as it is processed, either as an SQL retrieval or, for more complex variables, a server program.

## Version

A software version is identified by a letter at the end of the Software release number. For example 3.5.2e where e is a version of 3.5.2. Each version change represents an Upgrade of the System 21 software. Upgrades can be Full or PIP but both of these are represented by a new letter.

A Full Upgrade provides completely new software and has information files called EXPREADME.TXT, CONREADME.TXT and VERREADME.TXT.

A PIP Upgrade provides a short-term product improvement and updates only a limited number of files. A PIP Upgrade has information files called EXP352v.TXT and CON352v.TXT, where v is the version identifier.

## Visual Component

This is a user interface program that adds a Windows-style compatible application interface to a character based application. Visual Components are developed as 32bit Visual Basic, Microsoft Windows components. They do not

affect the server based business logic in any way and require no server side support. Visual Components work within the System 21 Explorer activity execution environment.

## Walkthrough

Please refer to the Walkthrough button on the Constructor Toolbar. You use this when you are designing a Business Process and want to review or demonstrate it.

Constructor takes you logically through the whole process stopping at each part of the design. Each time it hits an Assembled Activity or another Business Process it breaks it down into its lowest level components, including all its control icons. If there are Business Processes within Business Processes, then all these break down too. For example, you hit a Start Condition control symbol at the beginning of the whole process and then again at the beginning of each subprocess. Each time the walkthrough stops, you get a window of details.

## Workflow

The conventional term applied to toolsets that manage, control and automate the flow of work in a business process, but supplanted in JBA's products by the term Work Management.

## Work Management

The full title is Enterprise Work Management.

This is the term that describes JBA's implementation of activity task automation and control. The Work Management Engine is central to this processing and it is server based.

Constructor is the Graphical Design/Configuration Tool for Work Management. You configure the design of a Business Process and upload it to the Work Management Engine in order to enable it for Work Management. Work Management then controls the flow of work through System 21 Explorer by initiating activities and managing Action Lists. However, there are restrictions on the way in which you construct Business Processes if they are to be uploaded because the uploading process involves rigorous validation checking.

System 21 Explorer is the interface which Work Management uses to initiate its enabled activities.

## Work Management Engine

This is software which awaits incoming triggers which confirm the transactions that have been completed and may require the execution of a subsequent activity. There is a trigger for each completion state on a transaction, each one possibly generating a new pending transaction. The engine schedules new activities by putting them in a queue or adding them to a Action List. The engine supports parallel and serial execution of activities.

